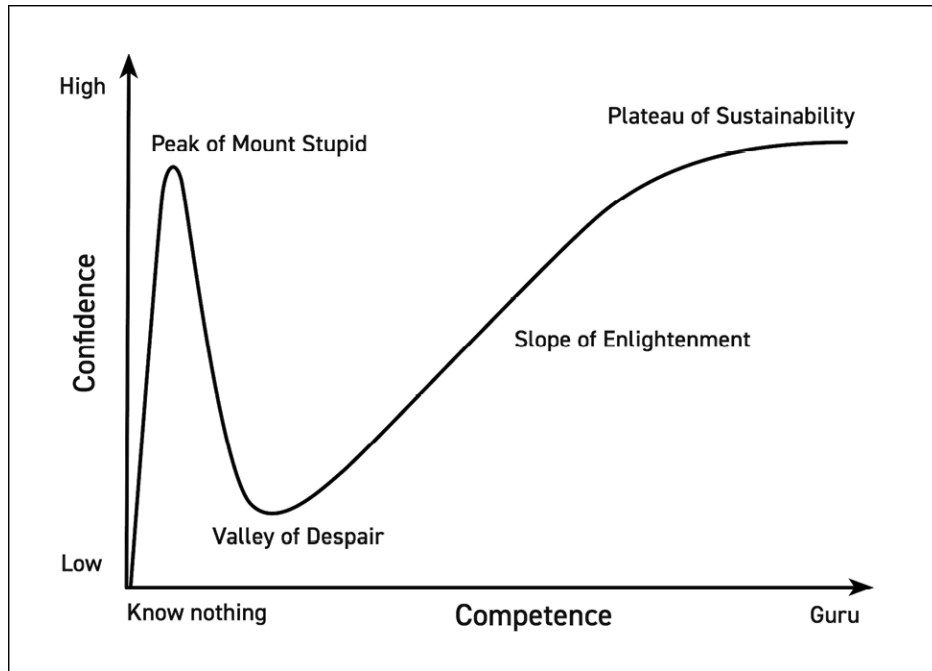


Dunning-Kruger Effect



Related to Dunning-Kruger is the DKE curve, which plots confidence against competence.³⁷³ If the DKE effect were not real, you would expect a gradually rising line from the lower left to the upper right of our metacognition chart. As we gain skills at a given task, our insight into our competence should rise along with our competence.

That's not what we see in real life or in the DKE curve. It shoots straight up to a peak—what some have called *Mount Stupid*—before crashing back to the *Valley of Despair*. It gradually rises slowly over time in a *Slope of Enlightenment*. Much later, it surpasses the initial peak in the *Plateau of Sustainability*.

Think of any task you perform that requires skill and competence. For me, that starts with music, then film, cooking, horology, architecture, cosmology/astronomy, auto-racing, tennis, boating, and investing. These are all things that I find interesting and have tried to do and learn more about.

Tennis might be the most accessible example. I was late to the game, and I only began playing seriously in my 50s. I thought I was pretty good, able to